one out of four corporate leaders at the CXO and vice-president levels is a Symbiosis alumnus. Shrirang Altekar, professor and director of the Symbiosis Institute of Business Management (SIBM), says the institute has incubated more than 100 startups. "We want students to be creators of jobs and not seekers of jobs," he says. Around 80 per cent of the curriculum is taught by faculty members, while the remaining 20 per cent is delivered by industry professionals. For the past four years, Symbiosis has also organised The Grand Pitch, modelled on the format of TV's *Shark Tank*, giving student entrepreneurs an opportunity to present their business ideas.

Abhijit Chirputkar, director of the Symbiosis Institute of Digital and Telecom Management (SIDTM), says the major focus is on interdisciplinary courses that add value. Management programmes, for instance, include credits from other disciplines. The university's academic and extracurricular infrastructure includes research cells, badminton and pickleball courts, gyms and dining facilities with Eat Right certification. Students can participate in semester exchanges, summer schools and winter schools at partner universities across Europe, including institutions in Germany, France, the Netherlands, Portugal and Belgium. "Here, teaching is not just about academics. It also integrates the newest trends and technology through our alumni

GURUSPEAK

"The combination of diversity and uncompromising academic standards is one of the university's greatest strengths"



DR VIDYA YERAVDEKAR
Pro Chancellor, Symbiosis International (Deemed University)

TOP 10

MOST IMPROVED GENERAL UNIVERSITIES (PRIVATE)

RANK	UNIVERSITY	CITY
1	SATHYABAMA INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY)	CHENNAI
2	GALGOTIAS UNIVERSITY	GREATER NOIDA
3	PRESIDENCY UNIVERSITY	BENGALURU
4	SAGE UNIVERSITY	INDORE
5	INTEGRAL UNIVERSITY	LUCKNOW
6	SANSKRITI UNIVERSITY	MATHURA
7	GLA UNIVERSITY	MATHURA
8	SWAMI VIVEKANAND SUBHARTI UNIVERSITY	MEERUT
9	CMR UNIVERSITY	BENGALURU
10	AMITY UNIVERSITY MAHARASHTRA	MUMBAI

Note: The Most Improved Universities are ranked based on their percentage growth in ranking over the past five years (2022–2026) in the India Today–MDRA Best Universities Ranking

TOP 5

PRIVATE UNIVERSITIES OFFERING HIGHEST NUMBER OF PG COURSES

RANK	UNIVERSITY	NO. OF PG COURSES
1	AMITY UNIVERSITY UTTAR PRADESH, NOIDA	116
2	SWAMI VIVEKANAND SUBHARTI UNIVERSITY, MEERUT	110
3	BHARATI VIDYAPEETH (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY), PUNE	104
4	INTEGRAL UNIVERSITY, LUCKNOW	73
5	CHRIST (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY), BENGALURU	69

TOP 5

PRIVATE UNIVERSITIES WITH HIGHEST NO. OF PATENTS FILED IN PAST THREEE YEARS

RANK	UNIVERSITY	NO. OF PATENTS
1	JAIN (DEEMED-TO-BE UNIVERSITY), BENGALURU	3,621
2	GALGOTIAS UNIVERSITY, GREATER NOIDA	2,928
3	CHANDIGARH UNIVERSITY, MOHALI	2,396
4	CHITKARA UNIVERSITY, PATIALA	2,083
5	SANSKRITI UNIVERSITY, MATHURA	1,904